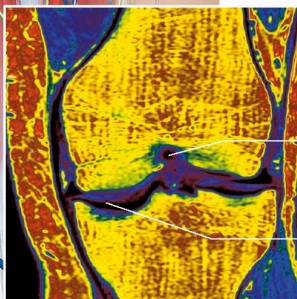


INTERIOR OF THE KNEE

The meeting of the femur and tibia forms the body's largest joint (articulation), the knee.

**Cruciate ligaments**

Form a cross shape from back to front of joint to provide stability

Meniscus

One of the two wedges of cartilage that help to distribute weight across knee joint

Muscle**Nerve****Patellar tendon**

Crosses over patella, which is embedded in it

Femur

Bone of the upper leg; also called the thighbone

Synovial membrane

Produces synovial fluid

Patella

Protective disc of bone and cartilage, also called the kneecap

Pad of fat

Acts as cushion between patella and knee, especially when kneeling

Articular cartilage**Artery****Ligament****Vein****Attachment of patellar tendon to tibia****Tibia**

Also called the shinbone; larger of the two lower leg bones

INSIDE THE KNEE

The knee is stabilized by external ligaments and tendons, and can "lock" straight to save energy and maintain posture while standing. It also has internal cartilages (menisci) and internal ligaments (cruciates).